



**The Honourable Chief Minister Shri Nitish Kumar issues appointment letters to outstanding athletes under "Medal Lao, Naukri Pao" Scheme.**

being built to address athletes' financial, health, and social needs, ensuring they remain connected to Bihar and motivated to represent their home state on the national and global stage.

**Asian Women's Championship Trophy 2024:** In 2024, the Government of Bihar will take centre stage as the title sponsor and co-host of the prestigious Women's Asian Champions Trophy, scheduled from November 11-20, 2024. This landmark event will be a defining moment for Bihar, highlighting its growing role in promoting and supporting international sports. The tournament will shine a spotlight on Bihar's expanding sporting infrastructure and its passion for hockey, while also providing a significant boost to the local economy through tourism and global attention. Hosting the Hockey Women's Asia Champions Trophy 2024 is not only a prestigious honour but also a unique opportunity for Bihar to showcase its world-class sports facilities, rich cultural heritage, and organisational expertise. The event will leave a lasting legacy, enhancing the state's reputation on the international stage and elevating women's hockey across Asia. Named "Hockey Ka Parv, Bihar Ka Garv," the tournament will feature the top six Asian teams — India, Malaysia, China, South Korea, Japan, and Indonesia — competing for the championship. This event is poised to inspire a new era of sports excellence in Bihar.

The logo for the Bihar Women's Asian Champions Trophy 2024 encapsulates the rich cultural, historical, and athletic legacy of Bihar, reflecting the state's overall progress and its commitment to sports. The design incorporates the Bodhi Tree, symbolising enlightenment and Bihar's spiritual significance, alongside a hockey stick and ball, representing the focus of the event. Additionally, it highlights Rajgir's sports heritage, with earthy tones of brown, orange, and green forming the colour palette, connecting the land's natural beauty with its vibrant sports culture. This logo unites Bihar's past and present, illustrating the state's dual identity as a centre for spiritual and sporting excellence while underscoring its dedication to women's empowerment through sports.

The tournament's official mascot, "Gudiya," is inspired



**Bihar has implemented a comprehensive scouting system to identify young athletes from both rural and urban areas in sports like kabaddi and volleyball.**

by the house sparrow, the state bird of Bihar. The sparrow, once ubiquitous but now endangered due to habitat loss, embodies resilience and strength, mirroring the perseverance and determination of the athletes competing in the event. By selecting the sparrow as the mascot, Bihar symbolically underscores the importance of preserving identity and culture while also celebrating the spirit of resilience shared by both the sparrow and the women who will compete in this tournament.

**Sports Infrastructure:** The construction of new stadiums, training facilities, and sports academies is a key component of Bihar's comprehensive plan to elevate its sports landscape. A significant milestone in this initiative was the inauguration of the Rajgir Sports Complex by Shri Nitish Kumar, the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Bihar. This state-of-the-art facility, located in the picturesque town of Rajgir, represents a major advancement in the region's sports infrastructure, designed to provide training grounds for athletes and host regional and national-level events. The Rajgir Sports Complex is a vital part of Bihar's broader strategy to develop a thriving sports ecosystem, reflecting the government's dedication to nurturing talent and promoting youth participation in athletics. Spanning over 90 acres and divided into six blocks, the complex is meticulously designed to ensure that all necessary facilities for athletes and trainers are available within its campus. It includes provisions for 24 indoor and outdoor sports, such as cricket, football, hockey, volleyball, basketball, swimming, archery, cycling, table tennis, and sepak takraw, among others.

This initiative is poised to significantly boost sports development in Bihar, further cementing the state's commitment to fostering a culture of sports excellence. In addition to the above facilities, the state is also developing indoor sports complexes in all commissionerates: Magadh, Tirhut, Darbhanga, Bhagalpur, Munger, Purnia, and Saharsa.

These centres are designed not only to host national and international events but also to provide local athletes with access to world-class training facilities. All 38 districts now have Khel Bhawan catering to indoor games.